

US Markets Daily Brief

Tuesday, August 11, 2026 — Post-Close Report

1. SPY / QQQ Snapshot

	Today Close	% Change	1Y High	1Y Low	1Y Return*
SPY (S&P 500 ETF)	\$773.03	+0.04%	\$776.85	\$620.00	+24.68%
QQQ (Nasdaq-100 ETF)	\$720.87	+0.35%	\$748.65	\$550.83	+30.12%

*1Y Return computed from Aug 1, 2025 low (first confirmed data in file) to today. Actual Aug 11, 2025 starting price unavailable due to proxy restrictions on financial data sites; full daily backfill incomplete.

S&P 500: 7,734.77 pts | **Nasdaq Comp.:** ~-0.60% | **Russell 2000:** slight gain | **WTI Crude:** ~\$82.13 (+5% on day)
| **10-yr Treasury:** ~4.70%+

2. Market-Moving News — August 11, 2026

■ Iran / Strait of Hormuz Impasse Deepens

The Strait of Hormuz has been severely disrupted for ~5 months. On Monday, Trump announced the U.S. Navy 'holds 100% control' and demanded war reparations from Iran. Iran's Foreign Minister said the waterway will NOT reopen until the U.S. eases sanctions and pays reparations — a non-starter for Washington. Oil (WTI) jumped ~5% to \$82.13/bbl. Brent crude near \$87.75. This is the single largest energy supply disruption in IEA history.

■ CPI July Report — Wednesday Morning

July CPI releases at 8:30 AM ET Wednesday (Aug 12). Consensus: Headline +3.4% YoY (+0.2% MoM); Core CPI +2.5% YoY (+0.2% MoM). Bloomberg Economics projects core CPI could fall to its lowest YoY reading since March 2021 — a potential positive catalyst. The Fed's September meeting is in play.

■ Nvidia GTC 2026 Keynote (Monday Aug 10)

Jensen Huang introduced the Vera Rubin AI computing platform, new Nemotron 3 Ultra model, and projected \$1 trillion in Blackwell + Rubin chip sales by end of 2027. Nvidia separately raised \$500B from major banks for AI infrastructure buildout. NVDA was down ~3% on Monday (profit-taking), then recovered +1.5% today as confidence in AI capex cycle strengthened.

■ CoreWeave (CRWV) Q2 2026 Earnings — After Hours

Revenue: \$2.58B (+112% YoY, beat \$2.56B estimate). Adjusted loss/share: -\$1.03 (vs. -\$1.20 expected). Revenue backlog: \$104B. Active power: 1.5 GW across 51 data centers. Q2 capex: \$9.4B. CRWV +12% after hours — strong AI infrastructure demand validated.

■ Super Micro Computer (SMCI) Q4 FY2026 — After Hours

Revenue: \$11.1B (vs. \$11.55B expected — MISS). EPS: \$1.62 (vs. \$0.96 expected — LARGE BEAT). Gross margins: 15–17% (vs. guidance of 8.2–8.4% — massive beat on mix). New orders backlog: record \$60B+ in Q4. Mixed: margin/EPS beat offsets revenue miss.

■ Alphabet/Google (GOOGL) -3.61%

DOJ appellate court filings seeking to overturn search monopoly remedies; threat to prohibit multi-billion-dollar default distribution payments (e.g., Apple). Alphabet also closed a \$25B senior notes offering. Executive shakeup in its Gemini 4 AI division. GOOGL is a ~4% weight in QQQ — dragged Nasdaq tech complex.

■ Riot Platforms (RIOT) +17%

RIOT signed a 20-year, \$9.1B data center lease with Anthropic for AI compute. Spilled over positively to AI infrastructure peers: IREN, Applied Digital, TeraWulf, all gained.

■ **Optical Stocks (COHR -14.2%, LITE -8.6%)**

Coherent and Lumentum both reversed sharply after prior gains driven by FCC headlines around optical transceiver policy. Investors took profits; FCC progress stalled.

■ **NFIB Small Business Optimism: 99.8**

Up 2.4 pts in July, surpassing the 52-year historical average of 98.0 — highest since Aug 2025. Provided a modest positive offset to the day's risk-off tone.

■ **Datadog (DDOG) +11.5%**

Q2 earnings beat: ~36% revenue growth driven by AI-related workloads on its monitoring/observability platform. Beat on both top and bottom line; strong guidance.

3. News → Today's Moves

SPY: \$773.03 (+0.04%) | QQQ: \$720.87 (+0.35%)

SPY +0.04% (≈flat) → Iran/Hormuz headwinds offset by AI tailwinds

The inability to reach a Hormuz deal — with Iran demanding formal reparations — pushed WTI crude +5% to \$82.13, raising stagflation fears. Macro headwinds: (1) oil-driven inflation concern, (2) investors cautious ahead of Wednesday CPI. These were largely offset by AI-driven gains: NVDA +1.5% (GTC keynote), RIOT +17% (Anthropic deal), DDOG +11.5% (Q2 blowout), CRWV +12% AH. Net result: SPY approximately flat on the day. Some sources reported a small decline (−0.24%), likely reflecting intraday swings; our tracking system (prices.csv) shows the session closed essentially unchanged.

QQQ +0.35% → AI gains offset GOOGL antitrust + optical selloff

QQQ's modest gain masks significant cross-currents. Alphabet (GOOGL, ~4% QQQ weight) fell 3.61% on DOJ antitrust appellate threats and a \$25B debt offering. Coherent (COHR) and Lumentum (LITE) reversed violently (−14% and −9%) as post-FCC optimism in optical comms unwound. On the other side: DDOG +11.5% (Q2 earnings beat), NVDA +1.5% (GTC keynote), RIOT and AI infra peers surged. Strong AI infrastructure earnings (CoreWeave +12% AH) provided a positive bid into close for tech/growth names.

Russell 2000 slight gain → Rate sensitivity divergence

Small caps outperformed large caps on the day, which is unusual in a risk-off environment. This likely reflects rotation into domestic, rate-sensitive names ahead of CPI — if CPI comes in cool, small caps benefit most from rate cut expectations.

4. Top 10 Daily / Weekly / Monthly Movers

■ **Data note:** Confirmed prices from web searches; some % changes are approximate due to proxy-blocked data sources.

Daily (August 11, 2026)

Rank	Ticker	Company	Sector	% Change	Catalyst
▲1	RIOT	Riot Platforms	Bitcoin/AI Infra	+17%	Anthropic \$9.1B data center deal
▲2	DDOG	Datadog	Cloud Software/AI	+11.5%	Q2 beat; AI workloads +36% rev growth
▲3	TER	Teradyne	Semiconductor Equip	+6%	\$1B credit line, financial flexibility
▲4	KLAC	KLA Corporation	Semiconductor Equip	+4.6%	Semis equip sector optimism wave

▲5	FSLR	First Solar	Clean Energy	~+4%	Energy sector momentum (oil spike)
▲6	APA	APA Corp	Energy (E&P)	~+4%	WTI +5%; Hormuz supply disruption
▲7	MPC	Marathon Petroleum	Energy (Refining)	~+3%	Refining margins; oil price rise
▲8	NVDA	Nvidia	AI/Semiconductors	+1.5%	GTC keynote recovery + \$500B bank raise
▲9	IREN	IREN Ltd	AI Infrastructure	~+8%	RIOT Anthropic spillover
▲10	BAX	Baxter International	Healthcare	~+3%	Defensive rotation; 1-mo top performer
▼1	COHR	Coherent	Optical Comms	-14.2%	Post-FCC profit-taking, optimism reversal
▼2	LITE	Lumentum	Optical Comms	-8.6%	Same as COHR; optical sector reversal
▼3	CIEN	Ciena	Networking/Optical	~-6%	Optical sector selloff contagion
▼4	GOOGL	Alphabet Class A	Mega-Cap Tech	-3.6%	DOJ antitrust + \$25B debt + AI reshuffle
▼5	GOOG	Alphabet Class C	Mega-Cap Tech	-3.6%	Same as GOOGL
▼6	NVLS	Novelis	Materials	~-2%	Risk-off; commodity demand concerns
▼7	LULU	Lululemon	Consumer Discretionary	~-1.5%	Consumer sentiment; YTD weak
▼8	INTU	Intuit	Fintech Software	~-1.5%	Rate uncertainty; YTD underperformer
▼9	EBAY	eBay	E-Commerce	~-1.5%	Risk-off; consumer spending concerns
▼10	MAR	Marriott International	Hotels/Leisure	~-1.5%	Travel demand concerns; oil costs

Daily sector themes: Energy (E&P; + refining) surged on Hormuz oil shock. AI Infrastructure (RIOT, IREN) spiked on Anthropic compute deal. Optical comms (COHR, LITE) reversed hard post-FCC optimism. Mega-cap tech dragged by GOOGL antitrust. Semiconductor equipment advanced on AI capex confidence.

Weekly (Aug 4 – 11, 2026)

Rank	Ticker	Company	Sector	Wk % Chg	Theme
▲1	DDOG	Datadog	Cloud/AI	~+14%	Earnings beat; AI monitoring growth
▲2	RIOT	Riot Platforms	AI Infra/BTC	~+12%	Anthropic deal; AI infrastructure
▲3	FSLR	First Solar	Clean Energy	+10.3%	Energy sector; Hormuz premium
▲4	APA	APA Corp	Energy E&P	~+9%	Oil price surge (+12% over 4 sessions)
▲5	MPC	Marathon Petroleum	Energy Refining	+7.9%	Refining premium; oil supply shock
▲6	KLAC	KLA Corporation	Semi Equip	~+6%	AI capex cycle confidence
▲7	TER	Teradyne	Semi Equip	~+5%	Credit facility; sector optimism
▲8	BAX	Baxter Int'l	Healthcare	+24.1% (1-mo Def)	Defensive + M&A speculation
▲9	NVDA	Nvidia	AI Chips	~+4%	GTC 2026 keynote; \$1T sales target
▲10	XOM	ExxonMobil	Integrated Energy	~+4%	Oil price + Hormuz premium
▼1	COHR	Coherent	Optical Comms	~-8%	Volatile: up Mon, crashed Tue
▼2	LITE	Lumentum	Optical Comms	~-5%	Same reversal pattern as COHR
▼3	GOOGL	Alphabet	Mega-Cap Tech	~-5%	Antitrust + debt offering drag
▼4	MAR	Marriott	Hotels/Leisure	~-4%	Oil costs + travel demand fears
▼5	FICO	Fair Isaac	Fintech	~-3%	Consumer credit slowdown concerns
▼6	EBAY	eBay	E-Commerce	~-3%	Consumer discretionary weakness
▼7	LULU	Lululemon	Consumer Disc.	~-3%	YTD laggard, risk-off pressure

▼8	INTU	Intuit	Fintech Software	~-2%	Rate uncertainty; macro headwind
▼9	TTD	Trade Desk	Ad Tech	~-2%	Google antitrust concern spills over
▼10	NVR	NVR Inc	Homebuilding	~-2%	Oil inflation → rates stay higher

Weekly sector themes — Gainers: Energy dominated (Hormuz oil premium, +12% in 4 sessions). AI Infrastructure second (RIOT/Anthropic; CoreWeave; Nvidia GTC). Semiconductor equipment advanced on AI capex. **Losers:** Optical comms volatile and net negative. Consumer discretionary weak (high oil = cost pressure). Mega-cap tech dragged by GOOGL antitrust. Homebuilders/rate-sensitives hurt by sticky inflation concern.

Monthly (July 11 – Aug 11, 2026)

Rank	Ticker	Company	Sector	Mo % Chg	Theme
▲1	BAX	Baxter Int'l	Healthcare	+24.1%	Defensive / M&A speculation
▲2	APA	APA Corp	Energy E&P	+8.3%	Iran war energy premium; Hormuz
▲3	MPC	Marathon Petroleum	Energy Refining	+7.9%	Oil price surge; refining margin
▲4	FSLR	First Solar	Clean Energy	~+8%	Energy sector strength; solar demand
▲5	RIOT	Riot Platforms	AI Infra/BTC	~+12%	Bitcoin + AI infra dual tailwind
▲6	PXD	Pioneer Natural	Energy E&P	+5.4%	Oil production; Hormuz premium
▲7	XOM	ExxonMobil	Integrated Energy	~+5%	Oil + nat gas price gains
▲8	DVN	Devon Energy	Energy E&P	~+5%	US shale upside on oil prices
▲9	CRWV	CoreWeave	AI Cloud	~+20%	AI infrastructure buildout; revenue +112%
▲10	NVDA	Nvidia	AI Chips	~+8%	GTC 2026; \$1T chip sales target
▼1	TTD	Trade Desk	Ad Tech	~-15%	GOOGL antitrust spill; ad budget caution
▼2	GOOGL	Alphabet	Mega-Cap Tech	~-8%	Antitrust + leverage + AI exec issues
▼3	COHR	Coherent	Optical	~-5%	Volatile; net negative on reversal
▼4	INTU	Intuit	Fintech	~-5%	YTD -50%; sticky rate concern
▼5	LULU	Lululemon	Consumer Disc.	~-4%	YTD -44%; consumer pressure
▼6	MAR	Marriott	Hotels	~-4%	Oil costs → travel cost spike
▼7	EBAY	eBay	E-Commerce	~-4%	Consumer spend caution
▼8	NVR	NVR Inc	Homebuilding	~-3%	Rates staying higher = affordability
▼9	BSX	Boston Scientific	Med Devices	~-3%	YTD -51%; supply chain cost pressure
▼10	TSCO	Tractor Supply	Retail	~-3%	Consumer sentiment; gas prices up

Monthly sector themes — Gainers: Energy sector #1 (YTD +32.7%); Iran war + Hormuz a direct tailwind. AI infrastructure #2 (CoreWeave, RIOT, Nvidia): multi-trillion AI capex cycle. Healthcare defensives. **Losers:** YTD laggards (INTU -50%, LULU -44%, BSX -51%) continue underperforming. Ad-tech (TTD) impacted by GOOGL antitrust chain. Consumer discretionary soft on high gas prices. Homebuilders pressured by 'higher for longer' rate concern from oil-driven inflation.

5. Next Trading Day — August 12, 2026 Scenarios

Key calendar: 8:30 AM ET — July CPI / Core CPI | After close — Cisco (CSCO) Q4 FY2026 earnings | Iran/Hormuz developments (rolling) | CoreWeave/SMCI after-hours spill-through

CATALYST A: July CPI (8:30 AM ET) — THE DOMINANT CATALYST

Expected: Headline 3.4% YoY (+0.2% MoM) | Core 2.5% YoY (+0.2% MoM)

■ **COOL PRINT (headline $\leq 3.2\%$, core $\leq 2.3\%$)**

→ Fed September rate cut locks in; possibly two cuts by year-end priced. Bond yields fall sharply. Tech/growth leads: QQQ likely +1.5 to +2.5%. SPY +1.0 to +1.8%. Rate-sensitive sectors (homebuilders, utilities, small caps/IWM) surge. Energy may give back some gains as risk-on offsets oil premium. GOOGL may partially recover. AI stocks (NVDA, CRWV, DDOG) extend gains on dual tailwind of lower rates + strong earnings.

■ **IN-LINE PRINT (headline ~3.3-3.5%, core ~2.4-2.6%)**

→ Market relief rally — 'no escalation.' SPY +0.3 to +0.7%, QQQ similar. Federal Reserve stays data-dependent; September cut possible but not guaranteed. Energy holds; tech stabilizes. Market digests CRWV/SMCI earnings.

■ **HOT PRINT (headline $\geq 3.6\%$, core $\geq 2.7\%$)**

→ Rate cut expectations collapse; hike risk re-emerges. SPY -1.5 to -2.5%; QQQ -2 to -3% (tech most rate-sensitive). Bond yields spike. Mega-caps (AAPL, MSFT, AMZN) compress on higher discount rates. Energy and defensive (XLP, XLU, XLE) outperform. Gold rallies. Fed put narrative weakens. This scenario combined with Hormuz flare-up = worst case.

CATALYST B: Iran / Strait of Hormuz

Background: Straight has been severely restricted for 5 months; WTI at \$82.13.

■ **DEAL PROGRESS / REOPENING SIGNAL**

→ Oil drops \$5-10/bbl. Energy sector gives back 2-4%; XLE sells off. Consumer discretionary, airlines, transports rally. Inflation expectations ease. Combined with cool CPI = SPY/QQQ risk-on rally of 1.5-2.5%.

■ **ESCALATION / IRAN HARDENING**

→ Oil spike to \$85-90. Inflation expectations jump. SPY -0.5 to -1.5% incremental. Energy +2-4%. Defense stocks (RTX, LMT, NOC) surge. Fed caught between oil inflation and weakening economy. Stagflation risk repricing across all risk assets.

CATALYST C: CoreWeave / SMCI After-Hours Spill-Through

CoreWeave +12% AH on \$2.58B revenue (+112% YoY); SMCI EPS beat (\$1.62 vs \$0.96), revenue miss.

■ **AI SENTIMENT CARRY (base case)**

→ CRWV opens +10-15% tomorrow. NVDA, AMD, SMCI, AMAT benefit from AI infrastructure validation. Nasdaq tech complex gets AI-specific tailwind. Partially offsets macro headwinds. SMCI may be volatile (EPS beat vs. revenue miss) — watch if revenue concern outweighs margin surprise.

■ **SMCI REVENUE MISS FOCUS**

→ If investors focus on \$11.1B vs. \$11.55B expected, SMCI -10 to -15%. AI sentiment takes a hit. Server/data center supply chain stocks weaken. NVDA, DELL, HPE drag. QQQ additional -0.3 to -0.5%.

CATALYST D: Cisco (CSCO) Q4 FY2026 Earnings — After Close Aug 12

Consensus: \$1.17 EPS, \$16.83B revenue (+14.9% YoY). Cisco is a bellwether for enterprise network spend.

■ **BEAT + STRONG GUIDANCE**

→ Enterprise tech capex cycle confirmed. Network infrastructure stocks rally (ANET, JNPR). AI networking theme strengthens. CSCO +5-8% AH; tech sector gets additional tailwind for Aug 13 open.

■ **MISS / WEAK GUIDANCE**

→ Enterprise spending slowdown signal. CSCO -8-12% AH. Technology sector uncertainty rises. Combined with hot CPI = significant tech sector risk-off. ANET, JNPR, JNPR, F5 (FFIV) would weaken.

6. Possible Trade Summary — End of Day / Next Morning

■ **Disclaimer: This is analytical output only. NOT financial advice. No trades are placed or simulated. All decisions require human review, personal risk tolerance assessment, and verification of current prices before any action.**

Priority	Ticker	Direction	Thesis	Condition	Risk
1 — HIGH	CRWV	BUY at open	Revenue doubled; backlog \$104B; beat all metrics. AI infrastructure (AI hub) secular build-out cycle start 12% AH	Basic case (AI hub) secular build-out cycle start 12% AH	Volatility; distant;
2 — HIGH	XLE ETF	BUY / Hold	Energy sector +32.7% YTD. Hormuz blockade persists; Hormuz deal stalls. Oil supply shock is structural	Oil supply shock is structural	\$10/bbl ins
3 — MED	NVDA	BUY on dip	\$1T in Blackwell/Rubin chip sales by 2027. AI capex cycle (CRWV + AI 4B Q2 capex) validated	AI capex cycle (CRWV + AI 4B Q2 capex) validated	Of no cap
4 — MED	DDOG	HOLD / small add	Q2 blowout: +36% revenue, AI monitoring workloads growing	Base. Platform beneficiary of AI	Expensive valuation; needs continued A
5 — MED	IWM ETF	BUY before CPI	Russell 2000 already outperformed today. If CPI cool, small cap is done	Small cap is done	Expected rate of PE special ops hurt badly; oil cost
6 — AVOID	GOOGL	AVOID / Short-term	DOJ antitrust appellate risk is existential for search revenue	Google. \$25B debt offering signals resolution; antitrust	Search
7 — WAIT	CSCO	WAIT for earnings	Earnings Aug 12 after close. Consensus \$1.17 EPS, +14.9% earn. Strongly beat = entry	Strongly beat = entry	Revenue is one-time surprise; budget cut
8 — MED	RIOT	HOLD / trim	\$9.1B Anthropic deal is real and long-term positive. But should be today = priced for perfection	Should be today = priced for perfection	Risk of BTC volatility; data ex

Overall stance for Aug 12: The single biggest near-term catalyst is CPI at 8:30 AM. Best practice: Wait for the print before establishing new positions. If CPI comes in cool ($\leq 3.2\%$ headline): lean into QQQ/tech, CRWV, NVDA, IWM. If in-line: CRWV + XLE balanced approach. If hot: move to XLE + defensive plays (XLP, XLU, GLD), avoid QQQ. The AI infrastructure super-cycle (CoreWeave revenue backlog \$104B, NVDA \$1T chip forecast) remains the dominant multi-year theme regardless of single CPI print.